

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Politics as Public Conflict and Authoritative Resolution

CENTRAL FOCUS

Politics as Public Conflict and Authoritative Resolution

- [1] Politics is not just elections or party intrigue; it is a public process around conflict, decision and order. (PDF pp.95-99)

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- [2] A political situation exists when public issues generate conflict and require an authoritative, publicly binding resolution. (PDF pp.95-99)

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- [3] Liberal theory reads politics as reconciliation of conflicting interests through state-backed decisions and legitimate coercion. (PDF pp.101-102)

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v

- [4] Marxist theory reads politics as rooted in class domination, where apparent compromise masks suppression of class conflict. (PDF pp.102-104)

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SYNTHESIS -> Politics as Public Conflict and Authoritative Resolution is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Definitions, Chapter Spine and Essential Distinctions

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Definitions, Chapter Spine and Essential Distinctions

- [1] Gauba moves from the layman's narrow image of politics to a broader account of politics as a social process. (PDF pp.94-95)

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- [2] He argues that politics requires public conflict, not merely private disagreement, and that war is a failure of political solution rather than politics itself. (PDF.

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- [3] Easton's formulation adds the key element of authority: political decisions allocate scarce values in a manner treated as binding. (PDF pp.96-99)

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- [4] Liberal theory then presents politics as a process of conciliating interests and securing order, justice and welfare. (PDF pp.101-102)

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Thinkers, Positions and the Three Rival Social Images

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Thinkers, Positions and the Three Rival Social Images

- [1] It gives three rival answers to one core question: what kind of conflict or cooperation makes politics necessary? (PDF pp.100-107)

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- [2] "Explain/Discuss the nature of politics" → definitional + comparative directive: define the political situation (Easton/Gauba), then compare at least two rival.

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- [3] Doctrine reconstruction: political situation → authoritative allocation (Easton) → three rival views (liberal/Marxist/communitarian).

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- [4] This chapter explains why politics is treated as a social process, not merely as the study of state institutions. (PDF pp.95-100)

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SYNTHESIS -> Thinkers, Positions and the Three Rival Social Images is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Illustrations and the Liberty-Equality-Fraternity Matrix

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Illustrations and the Liberty-Equality-Fraternity Matrix

- [1] Reserved seats, taxation and similar distributive arrangements show how authoritative allocation binds both beneficiaries and contributors. (PDF p.99)

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- [2] The queue system or traffic-signal type example captures the liberal hope that institutional rules can reconcile competing claims. (PDF p.102)

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- [3] Marxist analysis would treat labour-capital compromise in class society as unstable because the underlying relation of dominance remains intact. (PDF pp.103-106)

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- [4] Communitarian analysis would read family breakdown, loneliness, crime or drug abuse in modern liberal society as signs of weakened social bonds. (PDF pp.101, 105)

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v

SYNTHESIS -> Illustrations and the Liberty-Equality-Fraternity Matrix is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Trap Repair, Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline

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Trap Repair, Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline

[1] Politics, for Gauba, is a public process of conflict and authoritative resolution, not a synonym for private quarrelling or war. (PDF pp.95-99)

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[2] Liberalism: many groups, limited conflict, reconciliation, common good, welfare orientation. (PDF pp.101-102)

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[3] Marxism: economic structure, class antagonism, dominant-class state, politics as suppression until classless society. (PDF pp.102-104)

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[4] Best UPSC line: politics can be read as reconciliation, domination, or common-good pursuit depending on whether society is imagined as plural individuals, classes.

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SYNTHESIS -> Trap Repair, Boundaries, Revision and Source Discipline is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: MacIntyre: Traditions, Practices and Internal Goods

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MacIntyre: Traditions, Practices and Internal Goods

- [1] Gauba names MacIntyre, Taylor and Sandel together as communitarian critics of the atomistic liberal self (PDF pp.101, 105), but a strong answer must not treat them.

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- [2] Claim: the self is unintelligible outside the narrative of a particular community and moral tradition; virtues are acquired only through participation in social.

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- [3] Evidence/mechanism: a practice has "internal goods" (excellence achieved through the activity itself) understandable and judgeable only from within its own.

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- [4] Significance: morality cannot be reconstructed from an abstract, tradition-free standpoint, as much liberal theory attempts; moral reasoning is always reasoning.

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SYNTHESIS -> MacIntyre: Traditions, Practices and Internal Goods is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Taylor: Dialogical Identity and Recognition

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Taylor: Dialogical Identity and Recognition

- [1] Charles Taylor – dialogical self and recognition (Sources of the Self, 1989; "The Politics of Recognition", 1994)

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- [2] Claim: the self is "dialogical," not monological – identity is formed through language and relationships with "significant others," and a person's.

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- [3] Evidence/mechanism: withholding or distorting recognition (of a person's or a group's identity/culture) inflicts real harm, grounding claims for recognition of.

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- [4] Significance: grounds communitarian/multicultural claims in the human need for recognition – a moral, not merely sociological, case for community.

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SYNTHESIS -> Taylor: Dialogical Identity and Recognition is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Sandel, the Unencumbered Self and Cautious Precursors

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Sandel, the Unencumbered Self and Cautious Precursors

[1] Michael Sandel – critique of the unencumbered self (Liberalism and the Limits of Justice, 1982)

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[2] Claim: targets Rawls's "original position," where parties choose principles of justice behind a "veil of ignorance," stripped of knowledge of their own particular.

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[3] Evidence/mechanism: real persons are partly constituted by their ends and attachments (family, community, tradition); a self that could stand wholly apart from all.

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[4] Significance: if the self is constitutively social, justice cannot be derived from a purely neutral, ends-independent standpoint; political community itself has a.

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SYNTHESIS -> Sandel, the Unencumbered Self and Cautious Precursors is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Communitarian Objections, Liberal Replies and Indian Application

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Communitarian Objections, Liberal Replies and Indian Application

[1] Objection (communitarian → liberal): liberal neutrality (the state should not favour any particular conception of the good life) is impossible and self-defeating –.

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[2] Objection (communitarian → liberal, Sandel's core charge): Rawls's "unencumbered self" behind the veil of ignorance is metaphysically false – real people cannot be.

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[3] India's constitutional balance of individual Fundamental Rights with community-oriented Directive Principles and Fundamental Duties is a structural illustration of.

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[4] Caste/community-based reservation debates are a live Indian example of the liberal (individual merit/equal treatment) vs communitarian-adjacent (group-based).

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SYNTHESIS -> Communitarian Objections, Liberal Replies and Indian Application is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

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Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture

- [1] "Explain/Discuss the nature of politics" → definitional + comparative directive:
define the political situation (Easton/Gauba), then compare at least two rival.
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- [2] "Examine the communitarian critique of liberalism" → critique-directive: state the
liberal position targeted, the specific communitarian objection (name the.
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v
- [3] "Distinguish MacIntyre, Taylor and Sandel" → strict distinguishing directive: three
separate mechanisms are required, not a shared paragraph.
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v
- [4] Thesis: politics can be read as reconciliation, domination or common-good pursuit
depending on the assumed image of society.
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SYNTHESIS -> Directive Decoding and Mark-Scaled Answer Architecture is best presented through
its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit ->
conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

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MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair

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- [3] Liberal theory reads politics as reconciliation of conflicting interests through state-backed decisions and legitimate coercion. (PDF pp.101-102)

|

v

- [4] Marxist theory reads politics as rooted in class domination, where apparent compromise masks suppression of class conflict. (PDF pp.102-104)

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v

SYNTHESIS -> MCQ Remediation and Trap Repair is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

CENTRAL FOCUS

PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice

- [1] UPSC shortcut: first identify the image of society behind the answer—individuals, classes, or community.

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- [2] Gauba names MacIntyre, Taylor and Sandel together as communitarian critics of the atomistic liberal self (PDF pp.101, 105), but a strong answer must not treat them.

|
v

- [3] Evidence/mechanism: a practice has "internal goods" (excellence achieved through the activity itself) understandable and judgeable only from within its own.

|
v

- [4] Limit: risks relativism – if morality is tradition-bound, how do we judge between rival traditions or criticise our own? MacIntyre's answer (traditions can be.

|
v

SYNTHESIS -> PYQ Ownership and Answer Practice is best presented through its central claim, causal logic, strongest limit and qualified verdict.

EXAM ROUTE -> define precisely -> explain the mechanism -> test the limit -> conclude with a qualified political judgment.